

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1473

By Reeves

A RESOLUTION to honor Leadership Franklin on the occasion of the organization's thirtieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pause to specially recognize those estimable organizations that encourage success and effective leadership by their participants; and

WHEREAS, one such notable organization is Leadership Franklin, which is celebrating its thirtieth anniversary in 2026; and

WHEREAS, Leadership Franklin was established in 1996 with an initial board of directors consisting of Julian Bibb III, Caroline Cross, Jim Cross, Gayle Moyer-Harris, and Richard Herrington; and

WHEREAS, Leadership Franklin was created for the purpose of bringing together existing leaders within the Franklin community who represent a wide range of disciplines and diverse backgrounds for a ten-month program that equips those leaders with an understanding of the many issues facing Franklin; and

WHEREAS, over the course of each ten-month program, participants are exposed to the challenges and opportunities present in Franklin across a wide variety of areas, including history, health care, business, government relations, education, criminal justice, quality of life, tourism, economic development, entertainment, and land resources; and

WHEREAS, one of the central goals of Leadership Franklin is to enable participants to work together to make decisions that benefit the Franklin community; and

WHEREAS, more than 500 alumni have benefited from the program and alumni engagement opportunities offered by Leadership Franklin; and

WHEREAS, Leadership Franklin has contributed to more than 100 class projects benefiting the Franklin community, including the Jimmy Gentry statue erected in downtown

Franklin, ideas that led to the establishment of Bicentennial Park, the creation of both the Leadership Franklin Scholarship Fund and the Caroline J. Cross Service Award, the installation of a time capsule at the new City Hall, the painting of a mural within the Franklin Special District building, the development of a series of Franklin Legacy videos, and more; and

WHEREAS, Leadership Franklin is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and this worthy organization should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Leadership Franklin for its laudable service to the people of Franklin and this State, congratulate its current members and graduates on the occasion of Leadership Franklin's thirtieth anniversary, and applaud their determination to improve the quality of life for their fellow citizens.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.